



C#

Level 1

Convert String To
DateTime



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Definition

String to DateTime

 `DateTime.TryParse()` attempts to convert a string into a `DateTime`.

 It returns `true` if the conversion succeeds and `false` if it fails.

Explanation

`TryParse()`

 `DateTime.TryParse(str, out dt)` tries to parse the string and stores the converted date in `dt`.

 The result is stored in a `bool` variable to check whether the conversion was successful.

Valid Date

 `"6/12/2023"` is successfully converted, so `isValidDate` becomes `true`.

Invalid Date

 `"6/65/2023"` cannot represent a valid date, so `isValidDate2` becomes `false`.

Procedures

1. Store a date as a ``string``.
2. Create a ``DateTime`` variable for the output.
3. Use ``DateTime.TryParse()`` with ``out``.
4. Check the returned ``bool``.
5. Handle valid and invalid input accordingly.

💡 Example

```
str = "6/12/2023"
```

```
DateTime.TryParse(str, out dt)
```

➡ Result

Valid date: 6/12/2023 12:00:00 AM

Note

- ◆ `TryParse()` is safer than directly converting a string because it does not throw an exception when parsing fails.
- ◆ `out dt` receives the converted `DateTime` when parsing succeeds.

⊘ Warning

- ◆ Date strings can be interpreted according to the current culture/date format settings.
- ◆ If a specific date format is required, `DateTime.TryParseExact()` is more appropriate.

✦✦ Summary

- ✓ `TryParse()` converts a string to `DateTime` when possible.
- ✓ Returns `true` for successful conversion and `false` for invalid input.
- ✓ Useful when the input may not contain a valid date.

Thank you 😊